

Day 8 — Modern Lunar Science

Module: Moon Phases and Tithi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Phases as Sun's illumination of Moon; mention libration, tides.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *pañcāṅga* (IAST: pañcāṅga; lit. “five-limbed Indian calendar (tithi, vāra, nakṣatra, yoga, karaṇa)”)
- The Moon isn't really changing shape — the same ball is always there!
- The Sun lights up half of it. We see *different parts of the lit half* as the Moon goes around Earth.

Demo: hold a half-painted ball (one side bright, one side dark). Walk it around a child. The child describes what they see from each angle.

“*The Moon is always whole. We only see the bright part.*”

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *10-Day Moon Observation Diary* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.